

CARDIO-7 Clinical Trial Summary: Veltrozan for Hypertension

1. Study design

CARDIO-7 was a Phase III, randomised, double-blind, placebo-controlled clinical trial of the drug Veltrozan (20 mg once daily) in adult patients with stage 1 or stage 2 hypertension. A total of 1,240 patients were enrolled across 12 hospitals and followed for 52 weeks. Patients were randomised 1:1 to Veltrozan or placebo. The primary endpoint was the change in systolic blood pressure from baseline to week 52.

2. Efficacy results

At week 52, patients treated with Veltrozan had a mean reduction in systolic blood pressure of 14.2 mmHg, compared with 4.1 mmHg in the placebo group ($p < 0.001$). 68% of Veltrozan patients reached the target blood pressure of below 130/80 mmHg, compared with 29% on placebo. The effect was consistent across age groups and in patients with diabetes.

3. Safety and adverse events

The most common adverse events with Veltrozan were dizziness (9.3% vs 3.1% on placebo) and hyperkalemia, meaning high blood potassium (2.4% vs 0.6% on placebo). 4.8% of Veltrozan patients stopped treatment because of an adverse event, compared with 2.2% on placebo. No deaths were attributed to the study drug. Patients with kidney disease should have potassium levels monitored during treatment.